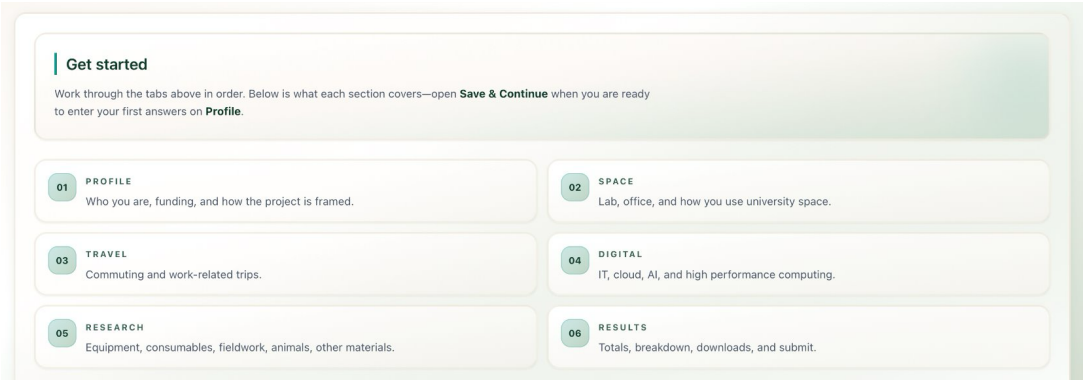
Tool for Research Accounting of Carbon Emissions User Guide

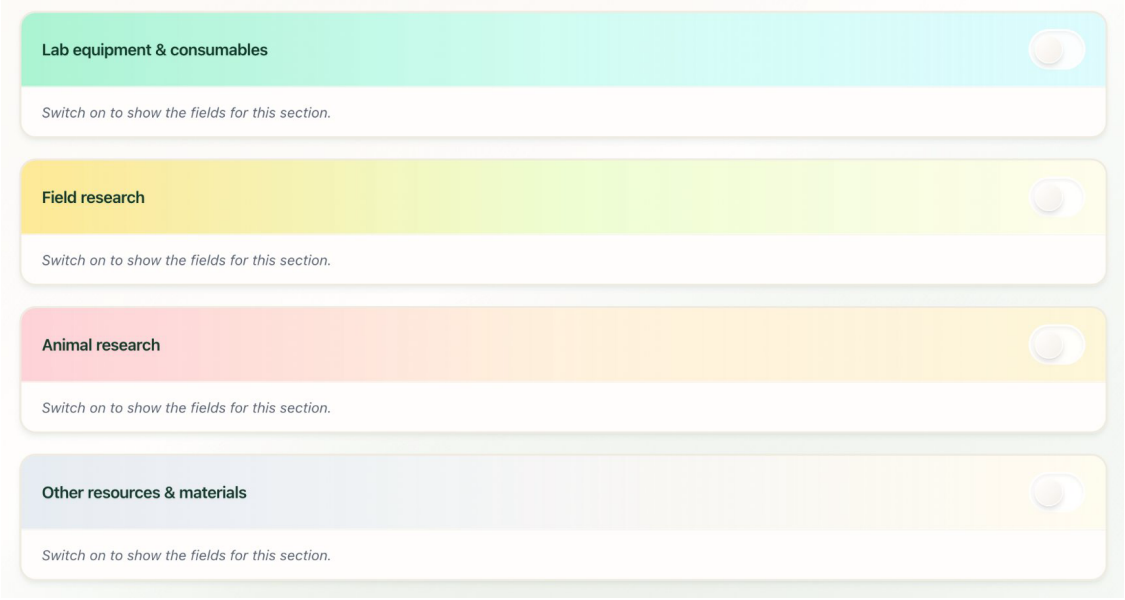
Queen's University Belfast

Working through your Report?

- You can create a new report using the "New Report" button in the navigation bar on the left-hand side of the webpage.
- Themes are split into steps: Profile, Space, Travel, Digital, Research, and Results. Complete every step that applies to your doctoral or research project. (It is worth scanning each step even if you think a section does not apply, so you do not miss a question that might be relevant.)



- On the Research step, optional topics (lab, field, animal, other materials) use a single switch per block: turn it on only when that topic applies to you.

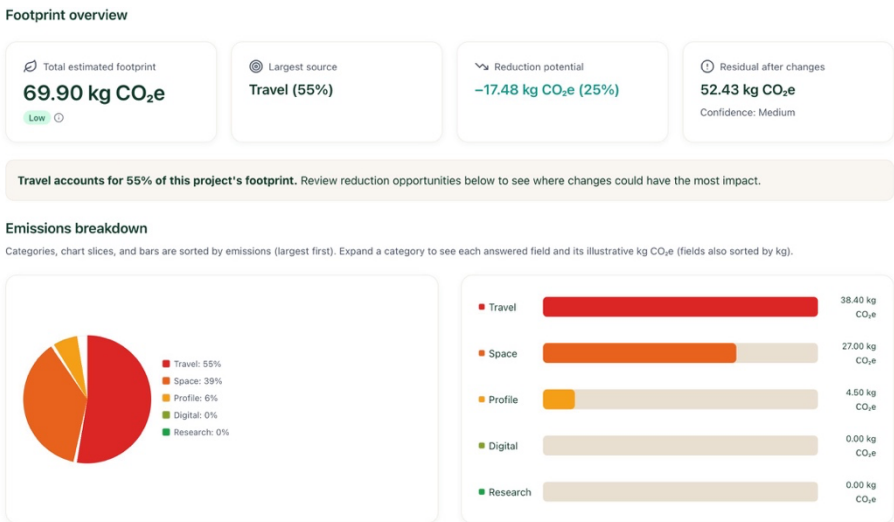


How to Answer?

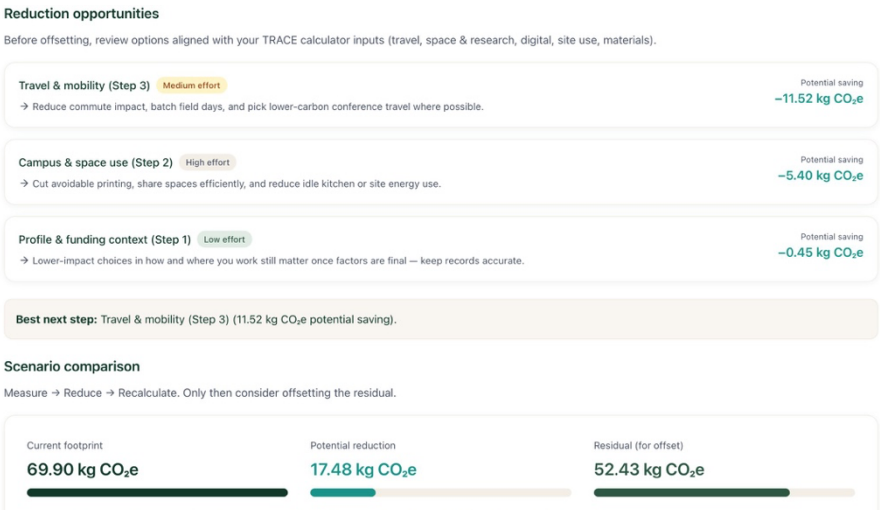
- Most questions use multiple-choice or banded options (e.g. hours per week, distance bands). Where you see a free-text or numeric box, use your best estimate if you do not have exact figures.
- If you choose “Other” or similar, a follow-up field may ask you to specify.
- Units and time scales differ between questions - check the label (e.g. per day, per year, kg, litres).

What the results represent?

- Consumables and equipment are grouped by carbon-emissions pathways. The tool does not claim to capture every gram of CO_2e for every student; it aims to estimate an average footprint for your research and to highlight areas that are likely to matter most.



- The results section additionally outlines some tailored reduction opportunities and provides a comparison footprint if these changes were actioned.



- Should the user wish to export their results for later reference this can be done at the top of the results page. An example format is a PDF summary of the results.

High Performance Computing

- To answer the HPC usage questions, use your kg CO_2e equivalents provided by the Kelvin-2 Team in their monthly reports. More information from the Kelvin-2 team on reducing the footprint of your HPC usage can be found here and from the Digital Humanities Climate Coalition here.